Curriculum Vitae

Kavya Agrawal, PhD Scholar, TERI School of Advanced Studies, New Delhi

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Profile

PhD scholar in Natural and Applied Sciences working at the intersection of groundwater systems, hydrogeochemistry, environmental geoinformatics and artificial intelligence. My doctoral work focuses on large-scale prediction and risk assessment of groundwater contamination, integrating groundwater observations with remote sensing, GIS and multi-source environmental data across uranium, fluoride and arsenic contamination. Methods include machine learning, deep learning, automated machine learning and spatial modelling, with broader interests in population exposure, environmental vulnerability, groundwater governance, water security, sustainable development and the cryosphere.

Education

2024 – present	**PhD, Natural & Applied Sciences** TERI School of Advanced Studies, New Delhi. Coursework CGPA 9.0/10.
2021 – 2023	**MA Geography** Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University, Agra. CGPA 7.60.
2018 – 2021	**BA (Honours) Geography** University of Delhi. CGPA 7.86.
2016 – 2018	**Senior Secondary School** Delhi Public School, Aligarh. CGPA 9.80.
2014 – 2016	**Secondary School** St. Francis Inter College, Hathras. CGPA 9.20.

Doctoral research

Thesis	**Development of an Explainable Machine Learning Based Framework for Multi-Contaminant Prediction**
Supervisor	**Prof. Chander Kumar Singhal**
Status	**Full-time PhD. Comprehensive examination completed 28 January 2026**
Coursework	**PhD coursework, 12 credits** ◦ RPR2… Research Methodology, 4 credits, grade A ◦ RPR2… Research Methodology, 4 credits, grade A ◦ NRE1… [illegible], 4 credits, grade A ◦ NRG1… Advanced Remote Sensing and GIS, Feature Extraction, 4 credits, grade A
Framework	**National-scale framework for groundwater contamination prediction and risk assessment** Combines geospatial, climate, hydrochemistry, remote sensing, GIS, climate, hydrology, terrain, soil, land use, and population information. Aims: contamination mapping, uncertainty and robustness assessment, environmental burden, exposure assessment and governance decision support.

Duplicate detection and duplicate-preservation rules
Administrative-name normalisation and
Coordinate validation and geometry reconstruction
Sentinel-value handling
Missing-value identification
GIS and remote sensing methods and
Source preservation and data lineage/provenance
Unit verification
Temporal and spatial compatibility checks
Resolution harmonisation
Masked-pixel handling
Time-series processing
Independent validation
Spatial data analysis and visualisation
Sustainability and climate policy
Land surface temperature
Urban Planning
Geomorphology
Political Geography
Agricultural Geography
Population Geography
Economic Geography
Historical Geography
Regional Development
Settlement Geography
Transport Geography
Geographical Thought
Cartography
Remote Sensing
Environmental Geography
Urban Geography
Research Methodology
Statistics
Quantitative Techniques
Climatology
Oceanography
Human Geography
Disaster Management
Hydrology
Geomorphology

Research experience

2025 – 26

Uranium in groundwater across India

A national-scale model of where uranium occurs in India's groundwater, built from groundwater observations and environmental predictors and checked against an independent validation dataset. The predictions are turned into spatial risk classes, estimates of population exposure, and governance indicators showing where monitoring and action are most needed.

Methods: automated machine learning (AutoGluon), independent validation, spatial risk mapping, exposure assessment.

Paper submitted to journal; Best Paper Award, ICSSR EHP NEXUS 2026

2026 –

Fluoride and the effect of spatial resolution

India-wide prediction of fluoride contamination, benchmarking deep learning models and testing how the resolution of environmental predictors changes the result. Predictor stacks are built in Google Earth Engine at native resolution and at 500 m, 1 km and 5 km, keeping every groundwater observation in the data.

Methods: deep learning, multi-resolution predictor extraction, 1.5 mg/L threshold.

In progress

2026 –

Downscaling and upscaling environmental predictors

A physically informed framework for moving satellite data between coarse and fine resolutions without inventing detail. A pilot on CHIRPS rainfall over Punjab (2013–2022) targets 5 km, 1 km and 500 m using sub-pixel fractions and conservation-based aggregation.

Methods: machine learning, conservation-based aggregation; validated with Moran's I, semivariograms and aggregation consistency.

In progress

2024 – 25

Arsenic in the Middle Gangetic Plain

The distribution, speciation and controls on arsenic mobilisation in the aquifers of the Middle Gangetic Plain, looking at geogenic and hydrogeochemical factors such as pH, iron, redox potential and sulfate.

Methods: hydrogeochemistry, explainable AI (SHAP, LIME).

Presented at As2024, Bhubaneswar

2023

Land surface temperature trends across the Indus River Basin

Spatial and elevation-wise trends in daytime and nighttime land surface temperature across the Indus River Basin.

Methods: Google Earth Engine (JavaScript), ArcGIS, Mann–Kendall and Theil–Sen trend analysis.

Published, Journal of Mountain Science

2023

Identification and mapping of permafrost in the Indus Basin

Mapping likely permafrost from about twenty years of mean annual air temperature (MAAT), potential incoming solar radiation (PISR), BMAT, snow and precipitation estimates in Google Earth Engine.

Paper in progress

2023

Snow cover and changes in Indian basins

Changes in snow cover across Indian river basins.

Paper in progress

Publications

2023 — **Evaluating spatial and elevation-wise daytime/nighttime LST trends across the Indus River Basin**
Mal, S., **Agrawal, K.**, Rani, S. et al. *Journal of Mountain Science* 20, 3154–3172. doi.org/10.1007/s11629-023-8157-8

2023 — **Analyzing the Possibilities and Prospects of 24/7 Water Supply in Delhi, India**
Sanu, S. K., Chandrakanta, **Agrawal, K.**, Sharma, V. R., & Bajaj, A. *Journal of Indian Water Works Association*, LV(1). UGC-CARE Group I, ISSN 0970-275X.

Manuscripts

2025–26 — **Predicting Uranium Occurrences in Groundwater throughout India**
Research paper
Submitted to journal

2026 — **Comparing and Benchmarking Deep Learning Models for Predicting Groundwater Contamination caused by Fluoride with the effects of Spatial Resolution on Prediction**
Research paper
In progress

2026 — **A Physically Informed Framework for Multi-Resolution Downscaling and Upscaling of Environmental Predictors (Satellite Data)**
Research paper
In progress

Conference presentations

Apr 2026 — **A Machine Learning-Based Framework for Uranium Risk Assessment, Population Exposure and Groundwater Governance in Urban India**
ICSSR EHP NEXUS 2026, Track X: AI and Predictive Analytics for Society and Environment, Gautam Buddha University, 27–28 April 2026. LinkedIn post
First Position, oral presentation, and Best Paper Award

Oct 2024 — **Distribution, Speciation and Controls on As Mobilization in the Groundwater in Aquifers of the Middle Gangetic Plain, India**
9th International Congress & Exhibition on Arsenic in the Environment (As2024), KIIT Deemed to be University, Bhubaneswar, 20–24 October 2024. Poster.

Nov 2022 — **Problems and Prospects of Delhi's Drinking Water Supply**
IGU Thematic Conference on Sustainability, Future Earth and Humanities, Department of Geography, Central University of Haryana, Mahendragarh, 24–25 November 2022.

Jul 2022 — **Educational Relevance of Ramayana in Modern India**
National Seminar on Promoting Human Values and Culture for Peaceful Co-Existence, Amity University Haryana, sponsored by ICPR, 22 July 2022.

May 2022 — **Digital Enhancement of Physical Space and Connective Turn in Tourism Industry during and Post-COVID-19 Period**
International Conference on Geography and the Digital: Intersections and Conflations, Department of Geography, Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi, 23–25 May 2022.

May 2022 — **Migrant College Students during Covid Pandemic: Evidence from the Field**
Jamia International Conference on Education 2022, Faculty of Education, Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi, 6–8 May 2022.

Apr 2022

Migrant College Students during Covid Pandemic: Evidence from the Field
International Conference on Challenges to Disaster Risk Reduction and Resilient Habitat, Centre for Disaster Management Studies, Shaheed Bhagat Singh College, University of Delhi, 5–6 April 2022.

Teaching

Jun–Dec 2026

Principles of GIS and GNSS (NRG176)
MSc Geoinformatics, TERI School of Advanced Studies. 4 credits, 60 hours (L-T-P 42-2-32).
Course teaching

Jun–Dec 2026

Principles of Remote Sensing (NRG169)
MSc Geoinformatics, TERI School of Advanced Studies. 4 credits, 60 hours (L-T-P 42-2-32).
Course teaching

Jul–Dec 2025

Principles of Remote Sensing (NRG169)
MSc Geoinformatics, TERI School of Advanced Studies. 32 practical learning hours.
Course taught

Projects

Postgraduate, 2021–2023

- Measuring the Problems and Emotions of Urban-Ward Migrants: A Case Study of Construction Workers in Delhi
- Monitoring the Effects of Light Pollution & Evaluating the Effectiveness of Indian Regulations
- Community Awareness, Participation, & CCDRR: Reflections from North-West India
- Experience of Migrant College Students During COVID-19 Pandemic
- Analyzing the Possibilities and Prospects of 24/7 Water Supply in Delhi, India
- Geography of Ramayana
- Digital Enhancement of Physical Space and Connective Turn in the Tourism Industry during and Post-COVID-19 Period

Undergraduate, 2018–2021

- Forest Monitoring & Urban Sprawl Analysis Using GIS in Delhi
- LULC Change Detection for 20 Years in South-West Delhi
- Social Indicators & Status Analysis of Jammu & Kashmir
- Socio-Economic Impact of COVID-19 in Delhi
- Snow Cover & Changes in Indian Basins
- HRVC Analysis of Jim Corbett
- Studying Human Trafficking in Delhi through Remote Sensing
- Understanding Ansal Plaza Mall of South Delhi as a Gendered Landscape: A Temporal Study

Other

- Working With Geospatial Datasets
- High-Quality Research Writing

Awards and achievements

2026

First Position, oral presentation, and Best Paper Award
ICSSR EHP NEXUS 2026, Gautam Buddha University.

Nov 2024

2nd Position, GeoPitch: 60 Seconds of GIS Work
MAPPIT, World GIS Day celebration, Geoscience Club, Amity Institute of Geoinformatics and Remote Sensing, Amity University Uttar Pradesh, Noida, 23 November 2024.

2018	**State Child Scientist Award** National Science Congress.
2015 – 2018	**Consecutive top 3 ranks, English Olympiads** British Olympiad Foundation.
2016, 2018	**Merit Awards**
	20 cultural and general knowledge awards From various organisations, including prizes in dance.

Rapporteurship and policy engagement

Mar 2026	**Rapporteur, National Workshop on Geospatial Technology for Climate Action, Sustainability and Disaster Risk Reduction** TERI School of Advanced Studies with the Regional Remote Sensing Centre–North, NRSC, ISRO, 16–20 March 2026. Also a volunteer for the programme.
Feb 2026	**Delegate, World Sustainable Development Summit 2026** Taj Palace, New Delhi, 25–27 February 2026. Transformations: Vision, Voices, and Values for Sustainable Development and Climate Action.
Mar 2025	**Rapporteur, Ministerial Session: NDC 3.0 and Multilateralism on the Road to COP30 and COP33** World Sustainable Development Summit 2025, TERI. India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, 6 March 2025. Session summary
Mar 2025	**Rapporteur, High-Level Plenary on Achieving Sustainable Development through Integrated Action** World Sustainable Development Summit 2025, TERI. India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, 7 March 2025. Session summary

Positions of responsibility

2026	**Facilitator and Judge, Programme LEAD 2026** TERI SAS. Sustainable City Design Challenge for students of classes 9–12.
Nov 2025	**Judge and Panel Member, TERI SAS Sustainability Hackathon 2025** Expert evaluation panel for school and undergraduate sustainability proposals, 18–19 November 2025.
2025	**Judge, KnoxCode 2025, Geospatial Innovation Challenge** Organised by GeoknoX, TERI SAS, as part of Aahwaan Fest 2025.
2018 – 2021	**Editor-in-Chief, Geography Association** University of Delhi.
2018 – 2020	**Magazine Coordinator, *Vani*** Shaheed Bhagat Singh College, University of Delhi.
2019 – 20	**English Editor, *Vani*** Magazine Committee, Shaheed Bhagat Singh College, University of Delhi.

Workshops, seminars and summits attended

Feb 2026	**Water as a Commons workshop, Water Governance Working Group** With the Ostrom Workshop, Indiana University Bloomington and IU India Gateway, 26–27 February 2026; included a Yamuna River field visit with INTACH Delhi.

Feb 2026	**Ambition to Action: Climathon, Delhi Climate Innovation Week** Climate Career & Sustainability Expo, Innovate X Delhi, 21 February 2026.
Feb 2026	**Guest lecture: Soil Carbon Sequestration as a Climate Mitigation Mechanism** Ms. Violeta Martinkė, Project Development Lead, InSoil, 13 February 2026.
Oct 2025	**Act4Earth Dialogue: Strengthening Multilateralism on the Road to COP30 and Beyond** Virtual, 17 October 2025.
Oct 2025	**Expert talk: DHI Urban Water Solutions** Mr. Morten Just Kjølby, Product Portfolio Manager for MIKE+, DHI Denmark, TERI SAS, 7 October 2025.
Sep 2025	**Science Summit 2025: Marine Resources for Sustainable Development** 16 September 2025.
Aug 2025	**QGreenland Educator's Workshop** Virtual, 5–7 August 2025, 12 hours. Center for Education, Engagement, and Evaluation (CEEE), University of Colorado Boulder, with CIRES and NSIDC. Developing educational activities with QGreenland data.
Jul 2025	**Roots to Resilience Seminar** TERI SAS with UNEP, UNESCO and Akashvani, 25 July 2025.
Mar 2025	**World Sustainable Development Summit 2025** New Delhi, 5–7 March 2025. Partnerships for Accelerating Sustainable Development and Climate Solutions. Rapporteur and volunteer.
Feb 2025	**National Science Day 2025** Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, 28 February 2025. *Empowering Indian Youth for Global Leadership in Science and Innovation for Viksit Bharat*, Department of Science and Technology, Government of India.
Oct 2024	**Lecture by Professor John A. Cherry on groundwater and sustainable development** 2020 Stockholm Water Prize laureate, 24 October 2024. Prof. Cherry also spent four hours at the Analytical and Geochemistry Laboratory, TERI SAS, discussing the lab's current and future work.
2023	**Workshop on Remote Sensing of Cryosphere (WRSC 2023)** Three-day workshop, Centre of Studies in Resources Engineering, IIT Bombay, with the IEEE GRSS Bombay Chapter.
	Climate Skills: Seeds for Transition TERI SAS and TERI with British Council and HSBC Bank.

Training, capacity building and schools

Mar 2026	**National Workshop on Geospatial Technology for Climate Action, Sustainability and Disaster Risk Reduction** TERI SAS with the Regional Remote Sensing Centre–North, NRSC, ISRO, 16–20 March 2026. Participant, volunteer and rapporteur.
Dec 2024	**Capacity Building Workshop on UAV/Drone Applications in Environment and Natural Resources Management: A Hands-on Training Program** Three days, TERI SAS with IIT BHU, IIT Roorkee, Namami Gange, Hokkaido University, Global Land Programme, GLP Japan, GuruJal (Abhipsa Foundation) and Kambil, 10–12 December 2024.

Nov – Dec 2024	**NGP-DST Winter School on Geospatial Technologies (Level 1)** 21-day capacity building programme, Amity School of Natural Resources and Sustainable Development, Amity University, Noida, supported by the National Geospatial Programme, DST, Government of India, 18 November – 7 December 2024. Grade A. Included a visit to Esri India.
Mar 2024	**Harnessing Geospatial Technology for Forest Fire Disaster Management: Mapping, Monitoring and Mitigation** One-week capacity building programme under the ISRO Disaster Management Support Capacity Building (DMS-CB) Programme, sponsored by IIRS, ISRO, Dehradun. Amity School of Natural Resources and Sustainable Development, Amity University, Noida, 11–15 March 2024.
Feb 2022	**Disaster Management Plans to Enhance Resilience of Institutional Buildings** Online training, National Institute of Disaster Management, Ministry of Home Affairs, with the Centre for Disaster Management Studies, Shaheed Bhagat Singh College, 23–25 February 2022.

Skills and working knowledge

Technical skills

Research and professional skills

Remote-sensing and environmental parameters

Earth observation, environmental and hydrogeochemical data

Data management, QA/QC and research reliability

Subjects studied

Future research interests

- **History and archaeology from space**: using satellite imagery, terrain models and GIS to read the past: tracing ancient settlements, palaeochannels and historical landscapes, and monitoring cultural heritage, building on my earlier work on the geography of the Ramayana.
- **The cryosphere of High Mountain Asia and the poles**: permafrost identification, modelling and assessment, and mapping change in glaciers, ice and snow across the Himalaya, High Mountain Asia, the Arctic and Antarctica.
- **Climate change**: assessments of climate change, its parameters and its impacts on water and people.
- **Groundwater policy in India**: turning contamination and risk predictions into evidence for groundwater governance and drinking-water policy in India.

Volunteering and co-curricular

2016 – present	**Volunteer, SWAPO NGO**
2019 – 2021	**National Service Scheme (NSS)**
2018 – 2019	**Coordination of Volunteers, Vasundhara**
2018 – 2023	**Personal blogging and content writing**

Personal interests

Collecting old coins and stamps, reading historic stories and accounts, photography and videography, travelling, badminton, dance, debating and Model UN.

Research keywords

Groundwater contamination; groundwater quality; groundwater quantity; hydrogeochemistry; uranium; fluoride; arsenic; groundwater risk assessment; population exposure; environmental vulnerability; groundwater governance; water security; environmental geoinformatics; geospatial data science; remote sensing; GIS; Google Earth Engine; machine learning; deep learning; AutoML; explainable AI; spatial modelling; spatial statistics; multi-resolution modelling; downscaling; upscaling; Earth observation; hydrology; climate–water interactions; hydro-environmental systems; cryosphere; permafrost; snow; glacier-fed hydrology; LST; climate change; sustainability; disaster risk reduction; policy engagement; environmental inequality; exposure assessment.

Contact

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